वैदिक शास्त्र दर्शन -वाज्ञज्ञ (Vēdic Vēdākshara-Insight -The Yajna of Speech)

Abstract
This paper examines *Vāgyajña*, the Vēdic sacrificial practice of speech, comprising *svādhyāya* (recitation) and *pravacana* (interpretive understanding). *Svādhyāya* externalizes latent knowledge through the articulation of sentences, sounds, and Vēdāksharas, while *pravacana* internalizes these expressions, encompassing both literal and inner meanings. Together, they enable mantras to become *śruti*, dependent on *svara* (intonation) to return to the practitioner and manifest spiritual efficacy.
Phonetic analyses reveal that *svādhyāya* embodies life, energy, effort, and orientation toward the manifest Absolute, whereas *pravacana* integrates the individual, mind, and knowledge to generate the Dēvatā -principle necessary for comprehension and realization.
Each Vēdic sentence is itself a mantra, and its recitation constitutes a yajña. Approaching the Vēda as yajña fosters spiritual growth, as exemplified in practices such as *japa-yajña* (mantra repetition) and *nirguṇa-dhyāna-yajña* (meditation on the attributeless), positioning Vēdic recitation and interpretation as an integrated, transformative practice.

Introduction
The knowledge of the meaning of Vēdic mantras possesses the capacity to transform, elevate, and guide the tendencies of living beings, leading them along the path of the *purohita* and ultimately bringing them to the primordial source of cognition - the innate knowledge (*saṃjñāna*) that is the cause of birth. The discipline underlying this endeavor is called **Vāg-yajña**, the Sacrifice of Speech.
Vāg-yajña consists primarily of two components: **svādhyāya** and **pravacana**.
The first, *svādhyāya*, refers to utterance,pronouncing the forms of speech, the structures of sound, and the forms of Vēdāksharas, projecting them outward through the organ of speech.
The second, *pravacana*, refers to understanding or interpreting what is uttered.
Thus, when we speak of *svādhyāya* as a constituent of Vēdic ritual, it signifies that the intuitive knowledge residing within us takes on the form of Vēdāksharas and becomes manifest.
The words spoken by living beings travel to others through the auditory faculty, thereby becoming knowledge for the listener. In the journey of knowledge, two sensory bases are involved: the **organ of speech** (*vāk-yantra*) and the **organ of hearing** (*śravaṇa-indriya*). The powers needed to shape sound so as to express imagination, feeling, and knowledge are inherent within us, enabling the muscles of the speech organ to move in the manner required to bring forth the intended Vēdāksharas.
Within the organ of speech, comprising regions such as the throat, palate, cerebral region, and lips, specific movements occur. During the effort to externalize Vēdāksharas, these components and their muscles act together to combine the necessary sounds and express outward, in the form of words, the meaning one intends to convey.
When these Vēdāksharas reach the auditory faculty of the listener, the muscles and nerves there respond, awakening the latent powers embedded in the Vēdāksharas themselves. This process enables comprehension. In this way, the two forces - speech and hearing carry the embodied meaning of Vēdāksharas to the domain of cognition, allowing knowledge to arise.
The divine potency inherent in each Vēdic Vēdākshara exists for the purpose of carrying one to the very source from which that Vēdākshara originates. The first three disciplines connected with the Vēda - **Vyākaraṇa** (grammar), **Śikṣā** (phonetics), and **Chandas** (metrics) are intimately interwoven with Vēdic Vēdāksharas and their governing principles. Through this interrelation, the *saṃhitā*-form of the Vēda leads one to primordial knowledge.
If the element of **intonation (svara)**, which belongs to Śikṣā, is absent, the Vēda loses its essential purpose. It is only through svara that the Vēda becomes **śruti**, that which is clearly heard. The Vēdāksharas and words that emerge outward from the organ of speech (*vāk-indriya*) must return, through the aid of svara, to the auditory faculty (*śravaṇa-indriya*) so that they can become bruit. Hence the Vēda is constituted as **mantra**, and Vēdic mantras must be *heard*. For them to be truly “heard,” **svādhyāya** is indispensable.

In this regard, the Taittirīya Āraṇyaka (5.9) states:
ṛtaṃ ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, satyaṃ ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, tapaś ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, damaś ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, agniś ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, agnihotraṃ ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, atithayaś ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, mānuṣaṃ ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, prajāś ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, prajanaś ca svādhyāya–pravacanena, prajātiś ca svādhyāya–pravacanena…
This mantra appears in the **Taittirīya Upaniṣad**, for the Upaniṣads form part of the Āraṇyakas, and the Āraṇyakas themselves are constituents of the Vēda. Therefore, the *saṃhitā*-nature present in all these textual layers grants meaning to Vēdic speech.
Just as in the *Kalpa* texts, where words such as *yajña*, *āyuḥ*, *prāṇa*, and *tapas* successively occur as principal terms in various sentences, so too in this mantra the expressions **svādhyāya** and **pravacana** appear uniformly in every sentence. Terms such as *ṛta*, *satya*, and *tapas* emerge one after another as the primary words of each verse. These are **great mantras**, for they articulate fundamental values in conjunction with the discipline of svādhyāya and pravacana.
The very Vēda that determines the meanings of the ritual terms found in the *Yajña–Kalpa* literature is also the authority that establishes the meanings of the expressions *svādhyāya* and *pravacana*. During the period in which such meanings were fixed, the structure of Vēdic speech existed in precisely this manner. Depending on the nature of one's effort, the structure of a sentence may change; yet every sentence is, in essence, a **mantra**, that is, something capable of steadying the mind and compelling it toward reflection and meaning.
Questions naturally arise as to why sentences change between the time of study and the time of recitation. Since each sentence is a mantra, **every act of recitation is itself a yajña (sacrifice)**. This is an extremely important insight. Within that yajña, determining the meaning of the sentence is both possible and appropriate. The surrounding sentences assist this effort, standing as supportive aids that guide us along the path of the *purohita*. The discipline that explains this principle is **Nirukta**, the science of etymological interpretation.
Concerning the meaning of *svādhyāya* and *pravacana* in this mantra, the Vēdic scholar **Bhaṭṭa Bhāskara** explains that *svādhyāya* means "the study of knowledge." Bhagavatpāda **Śaṅkarācārya**, interpreting from the standpoint of *akṣara-dṛṣṭi* (the vision of Vēdāksharas), conveys essentially the same meaning - *svādhyāya* as the activity of studying knowledge.
Viewed from the perspective of Vēdic Vēdākshara-science:

- The Vēdākshara **sa (स)** signifies **all living beings** (*sakala-prāṇa*).
- Within the Vēda, the Vēdāksharas **śa, ṣa, sa, and ha** are consistently used for sounds related to **prāṇa** (vital energy).
- The Vēdākshara **ha (ह)** denotes **one's individual prāṇa**.
- **sa (स)** denotes **the totality of prāṇa**.
- **ṣa (ष)** signifies **the prāṇa of all the deities**.

Just as the Vēda designates the syllable **ṣa (ष)** as the indicator of the *prāṇa* that pertains to all divine beings, it also assigns distinct meanings to the syllables **śa, ṣa, sa, and ha** within this sequence.
Thus:

- **ha (ह)** denotes **individual prāṇa**.
- **sa (स)** denotes **the totality of prāṇa**.
- **ṣa (ष)** denotes **the divine or cosmic prāṇa**.

When we operate in the human, worldly realm, our prāṇa is represented by **ha**. When we expand our awareness to embrace the entirety of creation, the force of our prāṇa assumes the form of **sa**. When a human being, or any living being, abides in a divine state, the Vēda expresses that condition of prāṇa through **ṣa**. The syllable **ṣa** therefore signifies states of prāṇa marked by **well-being, harmony, and tranquility**.
The syllable **va (व)** signifies **speech**;
the syllable **da (द)** denotes **the locus of divinity within us**.
When **da** is joined with the force of prāṇa, it becomes **dha (ध)**.
The syllable **ya (य)** expresses **effort or striving**.

Thus, *svādhyāya* is the effort undertaken to realize within oneself the essential nature of all beings in creation. Since the Vēda reveals the nature and consciousness (*caitanya*) of creation, this mantra naturally points toward **Vēdic recitation** (*Vēda-paṭhana*) as the meaning of *svādhyāya*.
Here, one ought to prepare a **table of Vēdāksharas** alongside their respective meanings, as established by Vēdic Vēdākshara-science (*akṣara-dṛṣṭi*).
The second term, **pravacana**, has likewise been interpreted in multiple ways. Ādi Śaṅkara and Raṅga Rāmānuja state that *pravacana* means **instruction or teaching**, that is, the teacher's act of facilitating the student's study. Bhāṭṭa Bhāskara, the Vēdic scholar, interprets *pravacana* as **exposition or commentary**.
A single Vēdic word within a single Vēdic sentence may yield multiple meanings, and different commentators provide different interpretations. This multiplicity is possible because Vēdic words, by their nature, are capable of expressing diverse yet valid meanings. Since the Vēda speaks of matters common to the world and must be preserved through oral transmission, some interpret *pravacana* as **the act of reciting the Vēda**.
Others, viewing the Vēda primarily as knowledge whose meaning must be understood and not merely recited, take *pravacana* to mean **explanation or commentary**.
From the standpoint of **akṣara-dṛṣṭi**, we first examine the structure of the word *pravacana*.
It is formed by the conjunction of the syllables:

- **pa (प)**
- **ra (र)**
- **va (व)**
- **ca (च)**
- **na (न)**

These combine in *saṃhitā* form to yield the word **pravacana**.
The syllable **pa (प)** pertains to the *three bodies* of the human being, namely, the physical, mental, and knowledge bodies. The second syllable, **ra (र)**, denotes the *individual being* (*jīva*). The third syllable, **va (व)**, signifies *speech*, specifically Vēdic speech. The syllable **ca (च)** represents *our consecrated or established state*. The syllable **na (न)** denotes *knowledge*, and **ma (म)** signifies *mind*.
In this context, "cakāra" refers to the *long form* of "ca," which the Vēda employs in the sense of *that which is produced* and *brought into manifestation*. When an action is undertaken as the *effort of the individual being*, the syllable **ja (ज)** is used, for here the "ya" - the syllable of effort, arises from the individual.
But when an act is performed in the *divine mode of consciousness*, the syllable **ca (च)** is used instead.
Thus, we find the mantra **"indraś cakāraḥ"**, found in the *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa*.
Indra, as a divine power, generates states of divine awareness. Those endowed with strong Indra-shakti transcend mundane existence and imagine realities from the higher priestly (*purohita*) standpoint; their thought arises from an elevated plane. Those whose Indra-shakti is weak remain distant from the expression "indraś cakāraḥ," finding satisfaction in commonplace worldly rituals.
There exists no yajña or sacrifice in the Vēda that does not cultivate the power of Indra.
Pravacana, therefore, is connected with *mind* and *knowledge*. When we engage the Vēdic voice while retaining the sense of "I," a synthesis (*saṃhitā*) occurs among the individual being, the mind, and knowledge. This synthesis generates the divine cognition required by the three bodies and transmits it to the individual. Those with other philosophical orientations receive the same meaning with renewed vitality.
The ancient teacher **Bhaṭṭa Bhāskara** offers one meaning; **Śaṅkara Bhagavatpāda** offers another; though their interpretations differ, both ultimately affirm the same principle. Since *pravacana* is intrinsically related to speech, it is "that which is spoken." It refers to articulated utterance. The syllable **pa**, when elevated from pertaining to a single body to all *three* bodies, assumes a superior meaning in the syllable **pra (प्र)**.
Thus, *pravacana* signifies **that which is recited in an exalted manner**,
that which is **heard**, which becomes **śruti**,
that which transcends ordinary speech and becomes **the melodic śruti of Vēdic chant**.
The moment this is heard, the process of reflecting on the meaning of the mantra begins.

In *svādhyāya*, the functioning of the vocal organ is primary;
in *pravacana*, the functioning of the auditory organ is fundamental.
Both functions are embedded within each other: hearing is implicit in recitation, and recitation is the foundation for hearing.
To teach, to explain, or to learn *pravacana* all imply that the Vēda becomes **śruti** for each listener.
Vēda is called **śruti** because it must be recited fully, with proper tone and pitch.
Both *adhyayana* (study) and *pravacana* (teaching or exposition) are called **Brahma-yajña** or **Vāk-yajña**, as the Vēda explicitly states. Every sentence in the Vēda is a mantra; every study and exposition of that mantra is itself a yajña.
The Vēda, which is the collection of these sentence-sacrifices (*vāk-yajñas*),
must therefore be understood **exclusively through the lens of yajña**.
When approached in this sacrificial manner, the sentence-sacrifice acquires divine potency and gradually expands. This is the essence of **Vāk-yajña**.

Discussion
In this section we will give some important points from the introduction and give Method numbers and References that will be explained in the next sections.
Vāgyajña (the sacrifice of speech) consists primarily of two components: the first is *svādhyāya* and the second is *pravacana*.
The first - *svādhyāya* is the act of utterance: the articulation of the forms of speech (*vākya-svarūpa*), the forms of sound (*śabda-svarūpa*), and the forms of Vēdāksharas (*akṣara-svarūpa*). Through this, what remains within becomes externalized through the organs of speech.
The second component - *pravacana* is the act of understanding what has been uttered, including both its literal meaning (sthūlārtha) and its intended or inner meaning (bhāvārtha) [Method-1, Ref (1)].
It becomes clear here that **the Vēda is called *śruti* precisely because of its dependence on *svara* (intonation)**. The Vēdāksharas and words that travel outward from the organ of speech, as *vaikharī* (the articulated form of speech), return again - through the agency of *svara* to reach the organ of hearing. Thus, the Vēda becomes a *mantra*.
The mantras of the Vēda must be *śrutis*, that is, they must be heard. For them to become *śruti*, **svādhyāya** is indispensable.
For example, by the very act signified by the word *śruti*, the mantra itself becomes *svādhyāya*. [Method-2, Ref (2)]
Just as every sentence is itself a *mantra*, the recitation of every sentence is a *yajña*. This is a matter of great significance. Within that yajña, the determination of the meaning of the sentence becomes both possible and attainable. The surrounding sentences function as auxiliaries to that interpretive effort; they stand as supportive assistants and guide us along the path of the *purohita* (the priestly method of interpretation).
For example, the mantra-yajña procedure of the Yajur Vēda itself serves as the *purohita* - the guiding principle for such interpretive work [Method-3, Ref (3)].
Svādhyāya signifies the effort undertaken to realize within oneself the essential nature of all beings in creation. Since the Vēda reveals both the form of creation and the consciousness inherent within it, the mantra here implies that *svādhyāya* also means *Vēdic recitation*.
Example (phonetic analysis of "svādhyāya"):
The term *svādhyāya* is formed from the sequence **sa + ā + va + dha + ā + ya + ya + ma + u**, each carrying a specific conceptual value:

- **sa** - the principle of manifestation as *all life* (*sākāra*, *sarva-prāṇa*).
- **ā** - the beginning or emergence of **śakti** (energy).
- **va** - *vāk*, speech.
- **dha** - the consonant *da* (the locus of the Dēvatā) combined with *ha*, indicating **energized divine placement**.
- **ya** - effort, exertion, striving (*yatna*).
- **ya** (second occurrence) - reinforcement of intentional action.
- **ma** - knowledge or cognition.
- **u** - *saguṇa Brahman*, the manifested form of the Absolute.

Thus, the word *svādhyāya* itself encapsulates a complete philosophical process:
the totality of life (sa), energized emergence (ā), expressed through speech (va), established in the divine locus (dha), pursued through disciplined effort (ya), inwardly known (ma), and finally oriented toward the manifest Brahman (u).
Pravacana fundamentally signifies *mind* and *knowledge*. When an individual engages with Vēdic speech from the standpoint of embodied self-awareness ("I"), a specific process unfolds: the *jīva* (individual being), the *mind*, and *knowledge* become united (*saṃhita*) and together generate the appropriate **Dēvatā -principle** required for the functioning of the three bodies. This generated Dēvatā -principle is then offered back to the *jīva* as its sustaining and guiding force.
Example - Phonetic Analysis of *pravacana* (Meaning: Understanding / Interpretation):
The term *pravacana* is constituted by the phonetic sequence:

- **pa-kāra** - denotes the *tri-deha* relation (the connection among the three bodies: sthūla, sūkṣma, kāraṇa).
- **ra-kāra** - signifies the *jīva*, the inner experiencer.
- **va-kāra** - represents *Vēdic speech* (*Vēda-vākya*).
- **ca-kāra** - indicates the *installation or generation of the Dēvatā -principle* (as in *indraś ca*, the act of invoking or establishing a devatā for function).
- **na-kāra** - denotes *knowledge* (*jñāna*).
- **ma-kāra** - refers to the *mind* (*manas*).

Thus, *pravacana* describes the integrated activity of:
jīva + mind + knowledge,
functioning together to generate the required Dēvatā -principle and thereby to interpret, internalize, and realize the meaning of Vēdic expression.
In this sense, *pravacana* is not merely "teaching" or "commentary," but a **psychic-sacral process** wherein the being, the mind, and knowledge collaborate in producing insight appropriate to all three bodies [Method-4, Ref (4)].
In the Vēda, each sentence is a mantra, and the study and recitation of these mantras constitute a yajña (sacrificial practice). The Vēda, being a compendium of such mantra-knowledge, should be approached solely from the perspective of yajña. When engaged with in this manner, each mantra gradually acquires and manifests a divine quality, thereby affecting spiritual growth; this constitutes the essence of mantra-knowledge. Examples of such practices include japa-yajña (mantra repetition) and nirguṇa-dhyāna-yajña (meditation on the attributeless) [Method-5, Ref (5)].

Methods
Method-1:
RigVēda (1-167 - 3)

- देवता: इन्द्रो मरुच्च
- ऋषि: अगस्त्यो मैत्रावरुणिः
- छन्द: निचृत्त्रिष्टुप्
- स्वर: धैवतः

मि॒म्यक्ष॒ येषु॒ सुधि॑ता घृ॒ताची॒ हिर॑ण्यनिर्णि॒गुप॑रा॒ न ऋ॒ष्टिः। गुहा॒ चर॑न्ती॒ मनु॑षो॒ न योषा॑ स॒भाव॑ती विद॒थ्ये॑व॒ सं वाक् ॥

Essence of RigVēda (1-167-3):
A cloud holds well that electricity called "ghRtAci" which like a sword pervades in hidden places and cools the water at night. This electricity can be nourished with gold.
Humans should seek out refined speech and eloquence that are like a pure woman suitable for discussions on knowledge and dharma attributed to scholarly assemblies.

Proposition:
The connection between the two paragraphs of the Essence of RigVēda (1-167-3) lies in the **metaphorical parallel between natural phenomena and human qualities**, emphasizing cultivation and refinement:

- **First paragraph (cloud and electricity):**

    - Describes a cloud holding potent energy (*"ghRtAci"*) that penetrates hidden spaces, cools water at night and can be nourished with gold.
    - Metaphorically, it highlights **potential, hidden power, and refinement through proper nourishment** (gold as a symbol of purity and enhancement).
- **Second paragraph (refined speech and eloquence):**
    - Advises humans to seek refined speech and eloquence, comparable to a pure woman in scholarly assemblies.
    - Metaphorically, this emphasizes **hidden intellectual or moral potential**, which flourishes through cultivation and engagement with knowledge (*like nourishing the electricity with gold*).

Connection: Both paragraphs stress the idea that **latent potential - whether in nature (electricity in clouds) or in humans (speech and intellect) requires proper cultivation to reach its full expression and utility**. The first uses a natural metaphor; the second applies the principle to human qualities.

Conclusion of Method-1:
The passages in the Mantra describe **two parallel processes of refinement**:

1. **In nature**:
   A cloud holds a subtle, penetrating electricity (*ghṛtāci*), hidden like a sword, which becomes effective only when properly nourished symbolized by enrichment with gold.
2. **In humans**:
   One must seek out *refined, dignified, eloquent speech*, likened to a pure woman suited for scholarly assemblies, because such speech carries the capacity to uplift knowledge and dharma.

These two metaphors point to a deeper principle:
a subtle internal energy (whether natural or verbal) becomes potent only when cultivated, purified, and expressed with clarity.
This principle directly connects to the description of **Vāgyajña**:
Vāgyajña also involves a *hidden-to-manifest* transformation:

- Through **svādhyāya**, the inner potential of sound - Vēdāksharas, words, meaning - moves from the unexpressed interior to external articulation.
  This is parallel to the cloud's hidden electricity becoming active and beneficial.
- Through **pravacana**, one refines and internalizes the meaning, transforming mere sound into *insight*.

This matches the idea of cultivating refined, dignified speech appropriate for higher discussions. Thus, the passages in the Mantra and Vāgyajña describe **the same process in two domains**:

Natural World (Cloud + Electricity)	**Human World (Speech + Understanding)**
Hidden energy is strengthened and made useful	Inner speech-energy becomes refined through svādhyāya
Nourishment (gold) makes energy potent	Meaning-analysis (pravacana) makes speech fruitful
Leads to cooling, protection, benefit	Leads to wisdom, dharma, upliftment

Core Connection
Both discuss the cultivation and elevation of a subtle internal force, electricity in the cloud, speech in the human so that it becomes useful, illuminating, and beneficial.
In short:
Natural energy and verbal energy follow the same law: refinement → manifestation → illumination.

Method-2:
Yajur Vēda (18-1)

- देवता: अग्निर्देवता
- ऋषि: देवा ऋषयः
- छन्द: शक्वरी

- स्वर: धैवतः

वाज॑श्च मे प्रस॒वश्च॑ मे॒ प्रय॑तिश्च मे॒ प्रसि॑तिश्च मे धी॒तिश्च॑ मे॒ क्रतु॑श्च मे॒ स्व॑रश्च मे॒ श्लोक॑श्च मे॒ श्र॒वश्च॑ मे॒ श्रुति॑श्च मे॒ ज्योति॑श्च मे॒ स्व□श्च मे य॒ज्ञेन॑ कल्पन्ताम् ॥१ ॥

Essence of Method-2:

- My speech (vā́jḥ) food and water, ghee, and energy,
- My prosperity (pra+svaḥ) and progeny,
- My proper conduct (pra+yatiḥ) and fortune,
- Mine are righteous bonds (pra+sitiḥ) and their fulfillment,
- My determination (dhṛtiḥ) and meditation,
- My ritual action (kṛtuḥ) the Soma Yajna, intelligence, resolve, good thoughts, strength, worship, and the senses,
- My sound (svaraḥ) the Vēdic intonations, and musical notes,
- My verse (ślokaḥ) praise and fame,
- My ears (śravaḥ) and renown,
- My Vēda (śrutiḥ) and the Brahmanas,
- My light (jyotiḥ) the eye, offspring, wealth, sacrifice, and illumination,
- My bliss (svaḥ) and the happiness of others,
- **By my yajña (yajñena)** may all become capable and accomplished!

Proposition:

- **Question:** In *svādhyāya*, what does the principle of all life (*sa*) signify?
  Answer: Yajña (sacrificial action).
- **Question:** In *svādhyāya*, what does speech (*va*) signify?
  Answer: Śruti (the Vēdic utterance).
- **Question:** In *svādhyāya*, what is the locus of the Dēvatā (*dha*)?
  Answer: My supreme resolve (*sankalpa*), the principle of proper conduct.
- **Question:** In *svādhyāya*, what does effort (*ya*) signify?
  Answer: The Soma sacrifice (*somayāga*).
- **Question:** In *svādhyāya*, what does knowledge (*ma*) signify?
  Answer: The happiness of others is my own happiness.
- **Question:** What is the meaning of "Vēdic Vēdāksharas are realized through *vāgyajña* and yajña"?
  Answer: Through yajña (sacrificial effort), insight arises; through proper resolve (*kalpa*), the movement of divine qualities becomes effective.
- **Question:** How is it evident that the Vēda is *śruti* by virtue of *svara* (intonation)?
  Answer: This mantra states that musical notes beginning with niṣāda and Vēdic intonations beginning with udātta are mine; hence, the Vēda is called *śruti* due to *svara*.
- **Question:** How can we assert that renown is my Vēda?
  Answer: Vēdāksharas and words, having traveled outward through the organ of speech (vākendriya), return via *svara* to the organ of hearing, thus establishing my Vēdic renown.

Conclusion of Method-2:

It becomes evident here that the Vēda is called *śruti* by virtue of *svara* (intonation). Vēdāksharas and words, having traveled outward through the organ of speech (*vākendriya*), return via *svara* to the organ of hearing (*śravaṇendriya*), thereby attaining the status of *śruti*. Consequently, the Vēda is inherently a collection of mantras. Vēdic mantras must necessarily be *śruti*, and for them to become *śruti*, *svādhyāya* (recitation and study) is indispensable. This research finding is substantiated through analysis of the Yajur Vēda mantra (18-1).

Method-3:

RigVēda (3-15-4)

- देवता: अग्निः

- ऋषि: उत्कीलः कात्यः
- छन्द: त्रिष्टुप्
- स्वर: धैवतः

अषाळ्हो अग्ने वृषभो दिदीहि पुरो विश्वाः सौभगा संजिगीवान्। यज्ञस्य नेता प्रथमस्य पायोर्जातवेदो बृहतः सुप्रणीते॥

Essence of RigVēda (3-15-4):
O Agni, the without an enemy, with your inherent strength and valor, illuminate all righteous and virtuous acts, making them supremely powerful and prosperous.
O Jāta Vēda, leader of the Yajña, triumphant in the highest adherence to dharma, and protector of the most excellent Brahmacharya ashrama, guide us to victory through your just and virtuous action.

Proposition:
- **Question:** Who is the foremost leader of the Yajña?
  Answer: Agni is the foremost leader of the Yajña.
- **Question:** Who is Jāta Vēda?
  Answer: He who knows the Vēda.
- **Question:** To whom is this Vēda more accessible?
  Answer: To a Brahmachari (one who is studying and disciplined in learning).
- **Question:** What is the benefit for a Brahmachari in learning the Vēda?
  Answer: According to this mantra (RigVēda 3-15-4), he attains strength, valor, and the performance of supreme righteous actions (dharma-karmas).
- **Question:** What is the result of acquiring these qualities?
  Answer: Like Agni, he becomes luminous, powerful, and the “unborn enemy” (ajātaśatru), free from adversaries.

Conclusion of Method-3:
The recitation of each sentence constitutes a yajña. The surrounding sentences serve as supportive auxiliaries, guiding the practitioner along the path of the *purohita* - the priestly method of interpretation.

Method-4:
RigVēda (8-7-10)
- देवता: मरूतः
- ऋषि: पुनर्वत्सः काण्वः
- छन्द: गायत्री
- स्वर: षड्जः

त्रीणि सरांसि पृश्नयो दुदुह्रे वज्रिणे मधु । उत्सं कवन्धमुद्रिणम् ॥

Essence of RigVēda (8-7-10):
The rays (of light) serve as delightful instruments of encouragement for Indra, filling him with three qualities: determination (*dhṛti*), affection (*sneha*), and receptivity (sweet *prōtsāha*).

Proposition:
- **Question:** In this mantra, what do the rays (*kiraṇas*) signify?
  Answer: The Dēvatā of this mantra is Marut; therefore, the rays represent the Maruts.
- **Question:** For whom are the rays bestowed?
  Answer: For Indra - that is, for the individual (*jīva*).
- **Question:** What qualities do the rays possess?
  Answer: They possess sweet encouragement (*madhuram prothsāha*), determination (*dhṛti*), and affection (*sneha*).
- **Question:** What are these sweet qualities filling?
  Answer: They fill the three vessels that are the three bodies: knowledge (*jñāna*), mind (*manas*), and speech (*pravacana*).

- **Question:** What does “filling” mean?
  Answer: Only the highest and most excellent aspects are filled; that is, it is the creation of divine consciousness (*devatā-bhāva*).

Conclusion of Method-4:
Pravacana signifies the mind and knowledge. By engaging with Vēdic speech from the standpoint of the individual self (*aham*), one generates the divine principle required for the three bodies. That is, the *jīva* (individual), mind, and knowledge together constitute a unified process that produces the divine consciousness appropriate for all three bodies and imparts it to the individual. This is substantiated through the RigVēda mantra (8-7-10).

Method-5:
RigVēda (5-63-6)
- देवता**:** मित्रावरुणौ
- ऋषि**:** अर्चनाना आत्रेयः
- छन्द**:** निचृज्जगती
- स्वर**:** निषादः

वाचं॒ सु मि॑त्रावरुणा॒विरा॑वतीं प॒र्जन्य॑श्चि॒त्रां व॑दति॒ त्विषी॑मतीम्। अ॒भ्रा व॑सत म॒रुतः॒ सु मा॒यया॒ द्यां व॑र्षयतमरु॒णाम॑रे॒पस॑म् ॥६॥

Essence of RigVēda (5-63-6):
Let us seek speech that shines with a reddish radiance, that is free from fault, imbued with the purity of waters, and resplendent with wondrous brilliance.
Just as moving clouds produce the deep resounding noise of thunder, so too do Mitra, Varuṇa, and the Maruts abide with exalted intelligence and bring forth abundant rain.

Proposition:
- **Question**: What qualities of speech are being praised in this Mantra?
  Answer: Speech is praised as possessing a reddish radiance (aruṇa-kānti), being free from fault (aparādha-rahita), associated with waters, and endowed with wonderful brilliance.
- **Question**: What is being sought in this Mantra?
  Answer: The Mantra expresses a desire to seek such pure, radiant, and luminous speech.
- **Question**: Why is speech compared to something associated with water?
  Answer: Because water symbolizes purity, nourishment, and clarity - qualities that refined speech should possess.
- **Question**: What natural phenomenon is described as moving and producing sound?
  Answer: Moving clouds that thunder and make noise are described.
- **Question**: Which deities are said to act like these clouds?
  Answer: Mitra, Varuṇa, and the Maruts are said to act in a similar manner.
- **Question**: What qualities of these deities are highlighted?
  Answer: Their excellent intelligence (good judgment) and their dynamic, powerful presence.
- **Question**: What do these deities bestow upon the world?
  Answer: They bestow abundance and rainfall (vṛṣṭi).
- **Question**: What does this imagery suggest?
  Answer: It suggests that divine forces, like thundering clouds, sustain the world through wisdom and the life-giving gift of rain.

Conclusion of Method-5:
Connection Between the Mantra and the Vēdic Principle of Mantra-Yajña
The two earlier passages in the Mantra describe **qualities of speech** (vāk) using cosmic imagery - radiant, faultless, water-bearing, brilliant speech and relate it to **divine forces** such as Mitra, Varuṇa, and the Maruts, who sustain the world through intelligence, order, and rain. These descriptions metaphorically depict speech as a **living, luminous, and purifying force**, comparable to natural phenomena like clouds, lightning, and thunder.

This directly aligns with the Vēdic doctrine that **every sentence in the Vēda is a mantra**, and that the **recitation (svādhyāya) and comprehension (pravacana)** of these mantras constitute a **yajña**.
In both sets of passages:

- **Speech is treated as a sacred, cosmic power.**
  - The earlier verses describe speech as radiant, pure, water-filled, and brilliant attributes of divine potency.
  - The Vēdic principle states that each uttered sentence is itself a mantra possessing divine agency.
- **Divine forces assist the refinement of speech.**
  - Mitra, Varuṇa, and the Maruts are portrayed as stabilizing intelligence and producing rain, symbolizing nourishment and clarity.
  - In the doctrine of mantra-yajña, divine qualities manifest through proper utterance, leading to inner purification and growth.
- **Speech, like natural forces, becomes transformative when rightly invoked.**
  - Clouds producing thunder and rain symbolize speech releasing meaning and spiritual nourishment.
  - Mantra-knowledge (vāk-jñāna) grows through recitation, similarly, nourishing the practitioner.
- **The process is itself a yajña (a sacred offering).**
  - Seeking pure, radiant speech mirrors the Vēdic act of offering refined sound in yajña.
  - Each mantra, when recited, becomes an act of oblation that gradually manifests divine qualities.

In essence
The cosmic imagery of rain, radiance, and thunder in the earlier passages symbolizes the **sacred dynamics of Vēdic speech**, which, when uttered and understood correctly, becomes a **mantra-yajña** that produces spiritual illumination just as rain nourishes the earth.

Conclusion
Vāgyajña, as articulated in the Vēdic tradition, underscores the inseparable interplay between *svādhyāya* (recitation) and *pravacana* (interpretive understanding) in the realization of mantra-knowledge. *Svādhyāya* externalizes inner consciousness through precise articulation of sentences, sounds, and Vēdāksharas, while *pravacana* internalizes and interprets these expressions, uniting the individual, mind, and knowledge to generate the requisite Dēvatā -principle. Together, they transform each Vēdic sentence into a living mantra, enabling its function as *śruti* and its participation in the yajña (sacrificial) process.
By approaching the Vēda solely from the perspective of yajña, practitioners facilitate the gradual acquisition of divine qualities inherent in mantras, promoting spiritual growth and self-realization. The phonetic and philosophical analyses of *svādhyāya* and *pravacana* further reveal that Vēdic recitation is not merely a ritual act but a psychic-sacral process integrating speech, cognition, and consciousness. Practices such as *japa-yajña* and *nirguṇa-dhyāna-yajña* exemplify this transformative potential, positioning Vāgyajña as a cornerstone of Vēdic spiritual praxis.

References
(1). RigVēda (1-167-3)
(2). Yajur Vēda (18-1)
(3). RigVēda (3-15-4)
(4). RigVēda (8-7-10)
(5). RigVēda (5-63-6)